Westbrook City Council

~ Regular Meeting ~

Date: Monday, July 6, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1207548452
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_07062026-1015

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *Summarization necessarily condenses and selects; for complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

Mayor's Message

Boards & Commissions Ordinance Overhaul, Free Student Transit Passes & the Mountain Division Trail [1:30]

Discussion Summary

Mayor Morse thanked staff and residents who joined the Portland Pride Parade, then previewed three items. Staff have completed a comprehensive review of the Code of Ordinances provisions governing the City's 12 boards, aiming to eliminate outdated/conflicting language, ensure each board is appropriately structured, and standardize agenda, meeting, minutes, and public-notice protocols; the proposed updates go to Council over two Committee of the Whole meetings, July 20 and September 14, with current board members invited to give feedback beforehand.

A July 20 agenda item will propose free, unlimited Metro transit passes for all enrolled Westbrook High School students (700+), expanding an original proposal limited to students outside the school's bus-service zone. The program would be capped at 30,000 rides/year, with the City paying $1.13 per ride actually taken, for a maximum annual cost of roughly $34,000.

Assistant City Administrator Jenny Franceschi presented an update on the Mountain Division Trail, a planned 50-mile rail trail from Portland to Fryeburg (roughly 10 miles already built). The remaining Westbrook-to-Windham segment (~5 miles, following the Presumpscot River from Bridge Street to the trail's current terminus in Windham) has a completed preliminary design. A stakeholder group (Presumpscot Regional Land Trust, Portland Trails, Gorham, Windham, and Westbrook) recommends submitting this segment to MDOT's 2027–2029 work plan (applications due early August); estimated cost is ~$16 million, with municipalities sharing a 10% match (~$800,000 for Westbrook) — not committed to tonight. In parallel, the group is pursuing a state Rail Use Advisory Council review (unsuccessful when last attempted two years ago) of a "trail within the rail bed" approach that could cut Westbrook's cost share by more than half, though that process is slower and uncertain. The Council will be asked to formally endorse the MDOT work-plan application via a resolve on the July 20 agenda.

Key Decisions

✓ **Informational — no vote taken.**

Action Items

None.

First Public Comment

Resident Comment on Federal Defense Authorization Act [11:02]

Discussion Summary

Dan Glover (90 Stroudwater St.) spoke about the proposed FY2027 National Defense Authorization Act, specifically Section 219 of the House version (Section 1217 in the Senate version), which he described as establishing a U.S.-Israel Defense Technology Cooperation Initiative; he urged the Council and residents to read the provision and contact Representative Chellie Pingree's office before the NDAA vote, and raised broader concerns about defense spending levels. No Council action or response followed.

Key Decisions

✓ **Informational — no vote taken.**

Action Items

None.

Orders of the Day — Second & Final Reading

Orders 2026-67, -68, -70 through -75 — Routine Items (Consent, Read by Title Only) [14:26]

Discussion Summary

All first-read June 15, 2026: the Bulletproof Vest Partnership grant, Beaver Pond Beautification, two replacement zero-turn mowers, three replacement one-ton trucks, a replacement single-axle plow truck, the FY2027 animal shelter contract, the $9,000 tennis court repair contribution, and the FY2027 annual vendor lists — see the June 15, 2026 meeting summary for item-level detail. Read together by title only at Vice President Shaughnessy's motion, with Order 2026-69 pulled out for separate consideration at Councilor Chau's request.

Key Decisions

✓ **Passed together by unanimous roll call, 4–0.**

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-69 — Public Safety Health & Wellness Screening Funds (Floor Amendment) [17:12]

Found on page 48 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Required a floor amendment: late-arriving final invoices from participating municipalities, plus a typo in the original allocation figures, required correcting the total amount to be redistributed from $104,993.91 to $110,590.13, Westbrook's authorized expenditure to Guiding Light Behavioral Health from $7,210 to $10,260,

and its authorized expenditure to Sigma Tactical Wellness from $2,485.63 to $15,220.63 (the large jump was the typo correction, not new spending). City Administrator Holmes explained Westbrook serves as the “host municipality”/fund administrator for this voluntary regional screening program, redistributing unspent allocations toward municipalities with more participating employees.

Key Decisions

✓ Amendment passed, 4–0.

✓ Order as amended passed final reading, 4–0.

Action Items

None.

Orders 2026-76 & 2026-77: Millbrook Estates TIF — Final Passage

Orders 2026-76 & 2026-77 — Millbrook Estates TIF District Amendment & Millbrook Estates III [23:16]

2026-76 found on page 158; 2026-77 on page 191 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Following the extended public debate at the June 15 first reading (opposition from abutting property owner Beth Paulson Omstead and resident Mark Fournier — see that meeting's summary), both required public hearings were opened tonight for the TIF district amendment (2026-76) and the new Millbrook Estates III district and Credit Enhancement Agreement (2026-77). Neither hearing drew any speakers, for or against. Mayor Morse, who had not been present for the June 15 discussion, voiced enthusiastic support for the project's design and renderings.

Key Decisions

✓ Order 2026-76 passed final reading, unanimous roll call, 4–0.

✓ Order 2026-77 passed final reading, unanimous roll call, 4–0.

Action Items

None.

New Business — Resolve (One Reading Required)

Resolve 2026-14 — Westbrook Strong 5K Road Race — Road Closure [26:20]

Found on page 243 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Authorizes closure of Captain Bill Hartley Drive to inbound traffic (William Clark Drive to Main Street), 7:30–9:30 AM, Saturday, July 18, 2026, for the Westbrook Strong 5K road race; Haskell, Forest, Stroudwater, and Main Streets will have volunteer and police/fire traffic control but no full closure. The presiding officer noted Councilor Rairdon (absent tonight) and his wife organize the race as a community fundraiser.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous roll call, 4–0.

Action Items

None.

Order 2026-78: Vallee Square Emergency Sewer Repair (First Reading)

Order 2026-78 — Confirming Emergency Sewer Repair Expenditures [28:30]

Found on page 249 of the packet.

Discussion Summary

Confirms $70,078.48 in emergency expenditures ($66,741.03 to Woods Excavating, $1,500 to Corey Electric, $904.66 to EJ Prescott, $645.66 to GraybaR, and $287.13 to Core & Main) for an emergency sewer repair at Main Street and Vallee Square. City Administrator Holmes explained a routine grease-blockage cleanup this spring instead revealed the sewer line had collapsed: grease buildup had eaten through the bottom of an asbestos-concrete pipe at a low point just downstream of a restaurant's service connection — a failure mode staff and multiple contractors said they'd never seen before. Crews reconstructed 100 linear feet of pipe at a 15-foot depth, completed May 29, 2026, with some initial (unrealized) concern it might disrupt the Vallee Square concert series.

Councilor Chau asked whether the underlying grease problem had been addressed. Wastewater Manager Katherine Kelley and staff said Code Enforcement Officer Mike Corey inspected grease traps at nearby businesses, issuing a Notice of Violation to Fajita Grill after finding its lateral line was a major grease source; affected businesses are now reported in compliance. Councilor Shaughnessy asked about comparable industrial pretreatment systems elsewhere in the City — a dissolved-air-flotation system at Schlotterbeck & Foss and a silica-dust pretreatment system at the Sigco glass company on Spiller Drive, both administered through the Portland Water District's industrial pretreatment program.

Key Decisions

✓ Passed by unanimous show of hands (first reading).

Action Items

None.

Closing

Second Public Comment, Referrals, Committee Reports & Executive Session [37:47]

Discussion Summary

No second public comment, no referrals, and no committee report updates. Council voted to enter executive session under 1 M.R.S. §405(6)-C (disposition of publicly held property), inviting the Mayor, City Administrator, Assistant City Administrator, City Clerk, Director of Economic & Community Development, Director of Planning & Code Enforcement, and City Solicitor; the transcript ends there. As with all executive sessions, no content from the closed-door discussion is available or reported here.

Key Decisions

✓ Motion to enter executive session approved by show of hands.

Action Items

None.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names and figures against the official packet and the city council roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the presiding officer) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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